

Cimzia (certolizumab pegol)



Pharmacy Coverage Policy

Effective Date: January 01, 2026

Revision Date: May 27, 2026

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Line of Business: Medicare

Policy Type: Prior Authorization

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Products Affected

Cimzia Starter Kit subcutaneous syringe kit
Cimzia subcutaneous syringe kit
Cimzia Powder for Reconstitution subcutaneous kit
Cimzia Starter Kit subcutaneous syringe kit
Cimzia subcutaneous syringe kit
Cimzia Powder for Reconstitution subcutaneous kit

Listed Indications

[Crohn's Disease](#)

[Psoriatic Arthritis](#)

[Rheumatoid Arthritis](#)

[Ankylosing Spondylitis](#)

[Non-Radiographic Axial Spondyloarthritis](#)

[Plaque Psoriasis](#)

[Polyarticular Juvenile Idiopathic Arthritis \(PJIA\)](#)

Crohn's Disease

Does the member meet all of the following criteria?

Criteria #1	The member has a diagnosis of moderately to severely active Crohn's disease.
Criteria #2	The member must be 18 years of age or older.
Criteria #3	For Part D requests: The member must have had prior therapy, contraindication, or intolerance with two of the following: • preferred adalimumab product [i.e. Humira (adalimumab), adalimumab-adbm, adalimumab-adaz] • preferred ustekinumab product (i.e., Stelara, Otulfi, Yesintek) • Skyrizi • Rinvoq • Tremfya For Part B requests: The member must have had prior therapy, contraindication, or intolerance with: • Remicade, Inflectra, OR Infliximab AND • preferred ustekinumab product (i.e., Stelara, Otulfi, Yesintek) or Tremfya *For Medicare Part B requests, the step therapy requirements do not apply if the request is continuation of prior therapy within the past 365 days.

Approval Duration

Initial	Certolizumab therapy will be approved in plan year durations or as deemed appropriate through clinical review.
Renewal	Certolizumab therapy will be approved in plan year durations or as deemed appropriate through clinical

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review.

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Psoriatic Arthritis

Does the member meet all of the following criteria?

Criteria #1	The member must have a diagnosis of active psoriatic arthritis.
Criteria #2	The member must be 18 years of age or older.
Criteria #3	For Part D requests: The member must have had prior therapy, contraindication, or intolerance with two of the following: • preferred adalimumab product [i.e. Humira (adalimumab), adalimumab-adbm, adalimumab-adaz] • Enbrel • Cosentyx • Preferred ustekinumab product (i.e., Stelara, Otulfi, Yesintek) • Skyrizi • Rinvoq • Tremfya For Part B requests: The member must have had prior therapy, contraindication, or intolerance with: • Remicade, Inflectra, Infliximab OR Simponi Aria AND • Preferred ustekinumab product (i.e., Stelara, Otulfi, Yesintek) *For Medicare Part B requests, the step therapy requirements do not apply if the request is continuation of prior therapy within the past 365 days. **Prior therapy with Simponi Aria applies to medical benefits only.

Approval Duration

Initial	Certolizumab therapy will be approved in plan year durations or as deemed appropriate through clinical review.
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Rheumatoid Arthritis

Does the member meet all of the following criteria?

Criteria #1	The member must have a diagnosis of moderately to severely active rheumatoid arthritis.
Criteria #2	The member must be 18 years of age or older.
Criteria #3	For Part D requests: The member must have had prior therapy, contraindication, or intolerance with two of the following: • preferred adalimumab product [i.e. Humira (adalimumab), adalimumab-adbm, adalimumab-adaz] • Enbrel • Rinvoq

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	For Part B requests: The member must have had prior therapy, contraindication, or intolerance with: • Remicade, Inflectra, Infliximab, or Simponi Aria *For Medicare Part B requests, the step therapy requirements do not apply if the request is continuation of prior therapy within the past 365 days. **Prior therapy with Simponi Aria applies to medical benefits only.
Approval Duration	
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Ankylosing Spondylitis	
Does the member meet all of the following criteria?	
Criteria #1	The member has a diagnosis of ankylosing spondylitis.
Criteria #2	The member must be 18 years of age or older.
Criteria #3	For Part D requests: The member must have had prior therapy, contraindication, or intolerance with two of the following: • preferred adalimumab product [i.e. Humira (adalimumab), adalimumab-adbm, adalimumab-adaz] • Enbrel • Cosentyx • Rinvoq For Part B requests: The member must have had prior therapy, contraindication, or intolerance with: • Remicade, Inflectra, Infliximab OR Simponi Aria *For Medicare Part B requests, the step therapy requirements do not apply if the request is continuation of prior therapy within the past 365 days. **Prior therapy with Simponi Aria applies to medical benefits only.
Approval Duration	
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Non-Radiographic Axial Spondyloarthritis	
Does the member meet all of the following criteria?	
Criteria #1	The member has a diagnosis non-radiographic axial spondyloarthritis with signs of inflammation.

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Criteria #2	The member must be 18 years of age or older.
Criteria #3	The member has had prior therapy, contraindication, or intolerance with two of the following:* • preferred adalimumab product [i.e. Humira (adalimumab), adalimumab-adbm, adalimumab-adaz] • Cosentyx • Rinvoq *Prior therapy applies to pharmacy (Part D) benefits only.
Approval Duration	
Initial	Certolizumab therapy will be approved in plan year durations or as deemed appropriate through clinical review.
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Plaque Psoriasis

Does the member meet all of the following criteria?

Criteria #1	The member must have a diagnosis of moderate to severe plaque psoriasis.
Criteria #2	The member must be 18 years of age or older.
Criteria #3	For Part D requests: The member must have had prior therapy, contraindication, or intolerance with two of the following: • preferred adalimumab product [i.e. Humira (adalimumab), adalimumab-adbm, adalimumab-adaz] • Enbrel • Cosentyx • Preferred ustekinumab product (i.e., Stelara, Otulfi, Yesintek) • Skyrizi • Tremfya For Part B requests: The member must have had prior therapy, contraindication, or intolerance with: • Remicade, Inflectra, or Infliximab AND • Preferred ustekinumab product (i.e., Stelara, Otulfi, Yesintek) *For Medicare Part B requests, the step therapy requirements do not apply if the request is continuation of prior therapy within the past 365 days.

Approval Duration	
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Polyarticular Juvenile Idiopathic Arthritis (PJIA)

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Does the member meet all of the following criteria?	
Criteria #1	The member must have a diagnosis of active polyarticular juvenile idiopathic arthritis
Criteria #2	The member must be 2 years of age or older
Criteria #3	For Part D requests: The member must have had prior therapy, contraindication, or intolerance with two of the following: • preferred adalimumab product [i.e. Humira (adalimumab), adalimumab-adbm, adalimumab-adaz] • Enbrel • Rinvoq For Part B requests: The member must have had prior therapy, contraindication, or intolerance with: • Simponi Aria *For Medicare Part B requests, the step therapy requirements do not apply if the request is continuation of prior therapy within the past 365 days. **Prior therapy with Simponi Aria applies to medical benefits only.
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Background

This is a prior authorization policy for Cimzia (certolizumab).

Black Box Warnings

- Increased risk of serious infections leading to hospitalization or death including tuberculosis (TB), bacterial sepsis, invasive fungal infections (such as histoplasmosis), and infections due to other opportunistic pathogens.
- Cimzia should be discontinued if a patient develops a serious infection or sepsis.
- Perform test of latent TB; if positive, start treatment for TB prior to starting Cimzia.
- Monitor all patients for active TB during treatment, even if initial latent TB test is negative.
- Lymphoma and other malignancies, some fatal, have been reported in children and adolescent patients treated with TNF blockers, of which Cimzia is a member. Cimzia is not indicated for pediatric patients.
- Malignancies have been associated with Cimzia but the rate is extremely small and no conclusion on causal relationship can be made at this time.

Other important factors, and warnings and precautions, to consider before prescribing Cimzia:

- Most patients who developed infections were taking concomitant immunosuppressants such as methotrexate or corticosteroids. Do not start Cimzia during an active infection. If an infection develops, monitor carefully, and stop Cimzia if the infection becomes serious.
- For patients who develop a systemic illness on Cimzia, consider empiric antifungal therapy for those who reside or travel to regions where

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mycoses are endemic.

- Malignancies have been associated with Cimzia but the rate is extremely small and no conclusion on causal relationship can be made at this time.
- Multiple sclerosis or other demyelinating events - exacerbation or new onset may occur
- Undifferentiated cytopenias or pancytopenia - advise patients to seek immediate medical attention if symptoms develop, and consider stopping Cimzia.
- Known hypersensitivity to certolizumab or any of its components
- Heart failure, worsening or new onset may occur
- Anaphylaxis or serious allergic reactions may occur
- Lupus-like syndrome
- Hepatitis B virus reactivation – monitor HBV carriers during and several months after therapy. If reactivation occurs, stop Cimzia and begin anti-viral therapy.
- Patients treated with Cimzia may receive vaccinations, except for live or live attenuated vaccines. No data are available on the response to live vaccinations or the secondary transmission of infection by live vaccines in patients receiving Cimzia.

Cimzia (certolizumab pegol) is a pegylated form of anti-Tumor Necrosis Factor-alpha (anti-TNF α). Pegylation allows for subcutaneous dosing every four weeks.

Certain inflammatory processes involve the overproduction of TNF α by the immune system. TNF α is one of the agents implicated in the autoimmune response leading to conditions such as Crohn's disease, rheumatoid arthritis, and psoriasis. Cimzia is an antibody that binds to circulating TNF α , thus diminishing the effects of this molecule in the inflammatory process. In vitro studies show that certolizumab is more potent and binds with greater affinity to TNF α than adalimumab and infliximab. Cimzia does not contain the Fc region and therefore does not activate the complement pathway or cause cell-mediated cytotoxicity.

Cimzia is indicated for reducing signs and symptoms of Crohn's disease and maintaining clinical response in adult patients with moderately to severely active disease who have had an inadequate response to conventional therapy. Cimzia is also indicated for the treatment of adults with moderately to severely active rheumatoid arthritis (RA), for the treatment of adult patients with active psoriatic arthritis (PsA), for the treatment of adults with active ankylosing spondylitis (AS), for the treatment of adults with active non-radiographic axial spondyloarthritis with objective signs of inflammation, for the treatment of adults with moderate to severe plaque psoriasis (PsO) who are candidates for systemic therapy or phototherapy, and the treatment of active juvenile idiopathic arthritis (pJIA) in patients 2 years of age and older.

Provider Claim Codes

For medically billed requests, please visit www.humana.com/PAL. Select applicable Preauthorization and Notification List(s) for medical and procedural coding information.

Medical Terms

Cimzia; certolizumab; Crohn's disease, Rheumatoid Arthritis, Psoriatic Arthritis, ankylosing spondylitis; non-radiographic axial spondyloarthritis; plaque psoriasis; polyarticular juvenile idiopathic arthritis; subcutaneous, pharmacy

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